

TEST & MEASUREMENT EXCITING TIMES AHEAD

New human interface devices like touch, gesture and speech recognition will take centre stage this decade, making it possible to analyse data like never before



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Test and measurement (T&M) instruments have remained the backbone of all manufacturing and service industries for several decades. But though they play pivotal role in most industrial segments, all the attention was earlier enjoyed by core industry devices. The scenario has, however, changed now. From being a less glorified performer, T&M instru-

ments have come to be recognised as star performers.

In 2009-10, the T&M industry in India grew by 10.8 per cent. The total market size today stands at Rs 8 billion—up from Rs 7.22 billion of the previous fiscal year. Ever-changing technology, application needs, advanced industrial environment and growing demands are inspiring T&M manufacturers to keep in sync. As a result, the T&M industry has witnessed

many changes in terms of technology upgradation, price competency and new products over the last few years.

Sectors driving the growth

Aerospace and defence, telecom, manufacturing, government and education sectors are the biggest growth drivers for T&M in India. These sectors need T&M and monitoring tools to help engineers accelerate the performance of computing and networking through high-speed serial technologies; apply digital RF technologies to create flexible wireless networks and mobile devices; incorporate embedded systems; and facilitate high-quality video through multiple digital formats and channels.

Apart from these traditional sectors, solar and LEDs are the prominent growth drivers today.

"The telecom sector needs instruments for high-frequency measurements. The defence sector needs high-reliability instruments and the educational sector needs low-cost instruments," says Chandmal Goliya, managing director, Kusam Electrical Industries.

The growth of T&M in the telecom sector has been fuelled by the fast growing subscriber base and arrival of new technologies like 3G, WiMAX and LTE. "There is a large requirement for on-site installation and service of equipment in telecom," says Manish Kwatra, CEO, Metro Electronic Products.

"For telecom applications which combine voice, video and data, devices